

Hidden Horrors: Comprehensive Reports and Statistics on CSAM



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CW-227

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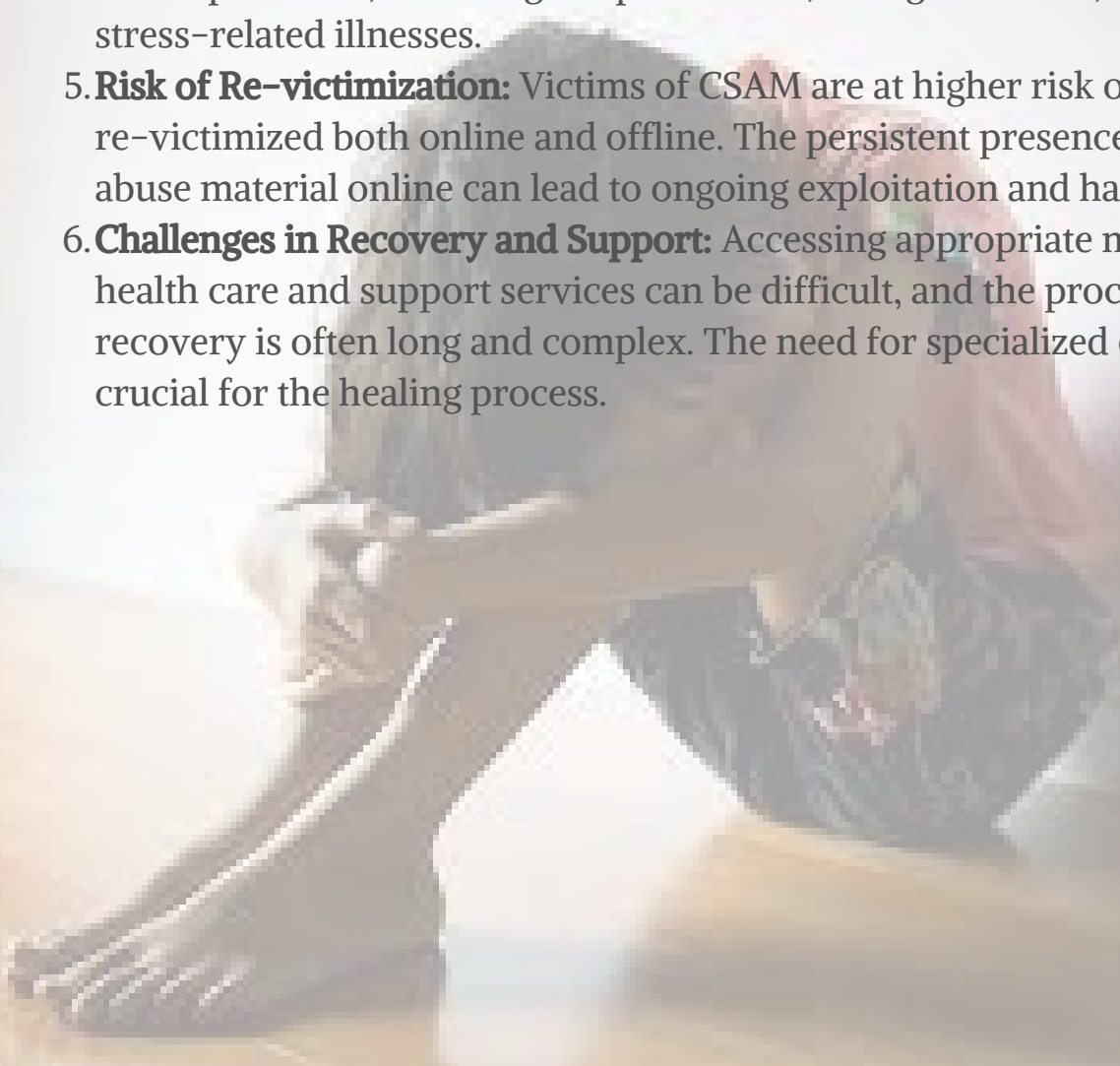
Thank you all for your contributions and support.

Komal Mishra

ABOUT THE HIDDEN HORRORS

The lifetime impact of Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) on children is profound and multifaceted, affecting various aspects of their well-being. Key impacts include:

1. **Psychological Trauma:** Victims often experience long-term psychological effects such as depression, anxiety, PTSD, and suicidal ideation. The trauma of the abuse itself, compounded by knowing the material is circulating online, exacerbates these conditions.
2. **Social and Emotional Consequences:** Children may struggle with trust issues, forming healthy relationships, and social isolation. The stigma and shame associated with the abuse can lead to a sense of hopelessness and low self-esteem.
3. **Cognitive and Academic Difficulties:** The stress and trauma can hinder cognitive development and academic performance. Children may exhibit difficulties in concentrating, learning, and maintaining academic progress.
4. **Physical Health Issues:** The stress and anxiety can manifest in physical health problems, including sleep disorders, eating disorders, and other stress-related illnesses.
5. **Risk of Re-victimization:** Victims of CSAM are at higher risk of being re-victimized both online and offline. The persistent presence of their abuse material online can lead to ongoing exploitation and harassment.
6. **Challenges in Recovery and Support:** Accessing appropriate mental health care and support services can be difficult, and the process of recovery is often long and complex. The need for specialized care is crucial for the healing process.



INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this report is to provide all stakeholders — including governments — with key information required to take effective action against the distribution and accessibility of CSAM on the internet.

CSAM perpetuates a cycle of victimization for children by stripping them of their personal safety and right to privacy, while inflicting great and lasting harm. Reducing the availability of this material must be a key pillar of child protection frameworks in our efforts to keep citizens safe.

We know that one of the keys to solving this problem is a deep understanding of the role that internet-based companies — especially those that accept user-generated content — play in facilitating access to and dissemination of abusive and illegal media.

The criminal nature of much of the material itself presents barriers from a research, public awareness and policy development perspective. Over time, these barriers have resulted in a limited understanding of the nature of the material, how it flourishes online and the manner in which it is distributed or accessed.

THE DANGERS OF CSAM AND CHILD EXPLOITATION

About 98% of reported CSAM involved children under the age of 13, with 30% under 10, including infants and toddlers.

With children now being exposed to the internet so young, they are vulnerable to online predators. Exploitation can have serious consequences — victims are more likely to struggle with trust, become isolated from family and friends, and develop mental health issues.



Definition of CSAM

Child Sexual Abusive Material (CSAM) refers to any visual depiction of sexually explicit conduct involving a minor (someone under 18 years of age). This includes photographs, videos, and digital images, as well as other media formats. The term encompasses a broad range of content that can include:

1. **Explicit Sexual Activity:** Images or videos showing minors engaged in sexual acts, whether with adults, other minors, or alone.
2. **Sexualized Posing:** Any content where minors are posed in sexually suggestive ways, even if no explicit sexual activity is shown.
3. **Digitally Created Content:** Computer-generated or altered images that depict minors in sexually explicit scenarios.
4. **Real and Simulated Content:** Both real images/videos of minors and those created or altered to appear as such, including deepfakes.
5. **Self-Generated Content:** Images or videos created by the minors themselves, often under coercion or exploitation.

CSAM is illegal and is recognized globally as a serious form of child exploitation and abuse. Efforts to combat CSAM include stringent laws, international cooperation, technology for detection and prevention, and extensive support services for victims.

Importance of addressing CSAM

Addressing Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) is crucial due to its profound and lasting impact on victims, the pervasive nature of its distribution, and the broader societal implications. Tackling this issue involves protecting vulnerable children, preventing future abuses, and holding perpetrators accountable.

Victims of CSAM suffer severe and long-lasting psychological, emotional, and physical harm. The abuse depicted in CSAM is not a one-time event; the circulation of these materials perpetuates the trauma. Victims often experience anxiety, depression, and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) due to the knowledge that images of their abuse are permanently accessible online. This ongoing victimization can hinder their ability to recover and lead a normal life.

PREVALENCE OF CSAM

The prevalence of Child Sexual Abusive Material (CSAM) is a pressing global issue, reflecting the widespread and growing nature of child exploitation and abuse. While precise figures are difficult to ascertain due to the clandestine nature of these activities, various studies, reports, and statistics shed light on the scope of the problem.

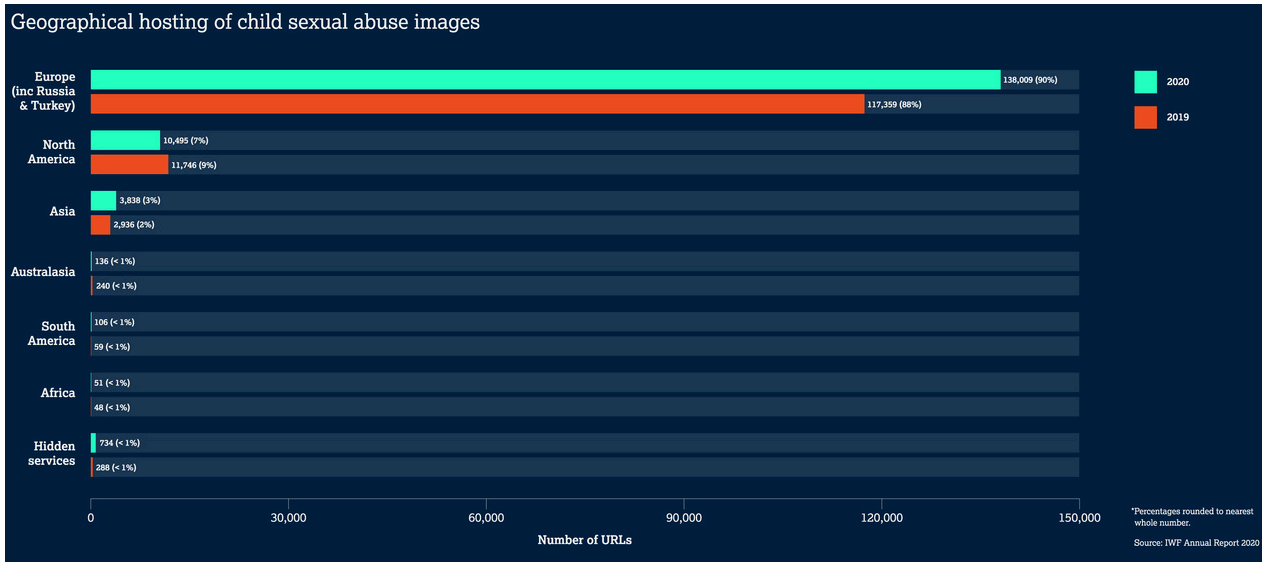
- **Internet and Dark Web:** The internet, especially the dark web, has significantly increased the accessibility and distribution of CSAM. Offenders use encrypted communication and anonymous browsing to share and trade abusive material.
- **Social Media Platforms:** Social media and instant messaging apps have become channels for the rapid dissemination of CSAM, often through covert groups and networks.

Global statistics of CSAM

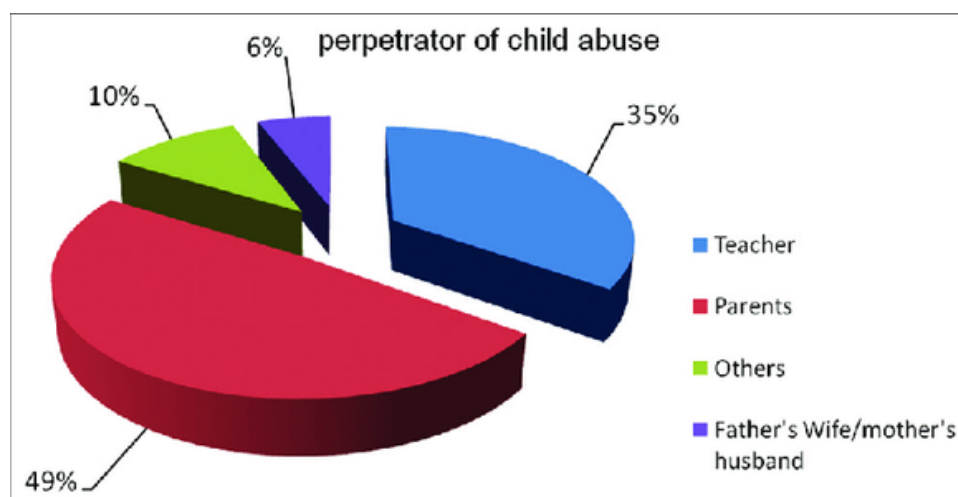
- In 2022, 64.5% of reported CSAM websites were in Asia, 5.2% in Europe, 8.3% in North America, and 10% in Africa.
- Between 2020 and 2022, India reported 13.1 million pieces of CSAM website content, the Philippines reported about 7 million, and Pakistan reported 5.3 million.
- In 2023, the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) received over 36 million reports of suspected child sexual exploitation to CyberTipLine and over 104 million CSAM-related files from registered Electronic Service Providers.
- In 2022, the NCMEC received 32 million reports of suspected CSAM from around the world, up from 29 million in 2021.

IWF declares a record year for online child sexual abuse reports at Annual Report 2023 launch

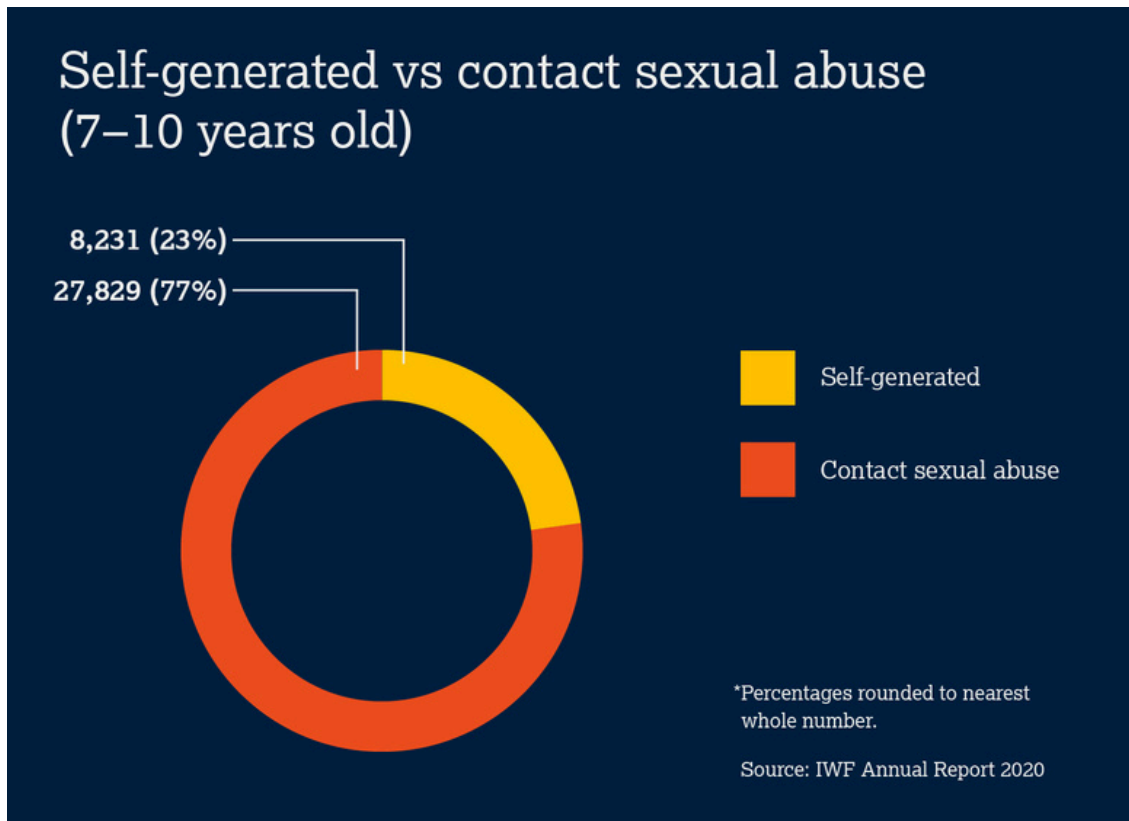
- Reports suspected to contain child sexual abuse imagery in 2023 : 392,665
- URLs (webpages) confirmed to contain child sexual abuse imagery : 275,652
- 92% of content removed contained "self-generated" child sexual abuse material



- 1. Volume of Reports and Materials:** In 2023, the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) received over 36 million reports of suspected child sexual abuse through its CyberTipline. These reports included over 104 million files related to CSAM.
- 2. Victim (information about people/combinations of different kinds of people):** Most CSAM shows (younger than about 13) children, with girls being more often showed than boys. However, when boys are shown, the tends to be worse. About 67% of identified victims are (younger than about 13) or younger, including infants and little kids.
- 3. Distribution and effect:** The internet has increased the distribution of CSAM. Abusers can now share materials around the world in an instant, leading to CSAM is not only used to satisfy the fantasies of collectors but also to revictimize and stalk the victims.
- 4. Criminals:** Most CSAM is created by people with legal/real and true access to children, such as family members, neighbors, or family friends. However, the internet has enabled predators to target, groom, and exploited children remotely.



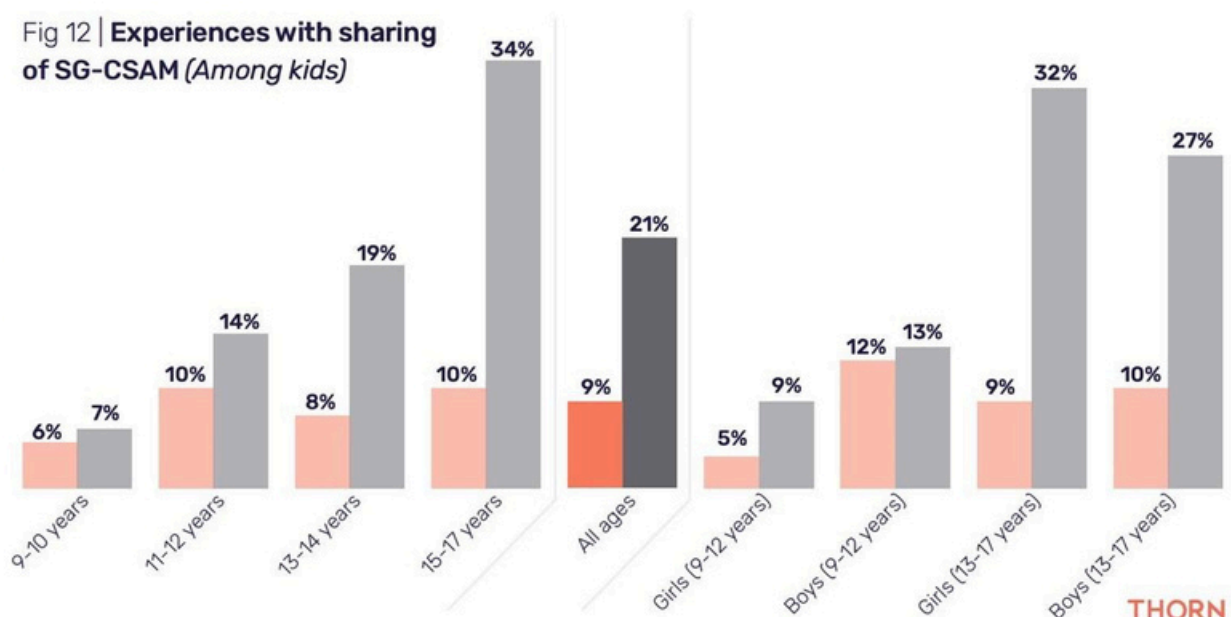
5.Self-Generated CSAM: A disturbing popular thing is the increase in self-created CSAM, where children, often forced or groomed, create and share clear content. This important thing is more and more seen among minors, with 1 in 6 children of age group 9–17 having shared such material. These images are often weaponized by predators to further use victims.



Have re-shared SG-CSAM

Have seen non-consensual SG-CSAM

Fig 12 | Experiences with sharing of SG-CSAM (Among kids)



[Q54] Have you ever sent or shared a nude photo or video of yourself either directly with someone else or with your social media followers? Please remember that your answers are anonymous. [Q65] Have you ever been shown or sent a nude photo or video of someone at your school or someone else your age in our community without that person's knowledge? [Q68] Have you ever shared a nude photo or video of someone else without that person's knowledge online?

Key Sources of CSAM

The sources of child sexual abuse material (CSAM) are varied and complex, often involving multiple platforms and methods of distribution. Here are the key sources:

1. Dark Web

- Anonymous Marketplaces: The dark web hosts numerous anonymous marketplaces where CSAM can be bought, sold, or exchanged.
- Encrypted Communication Channels: Platforms like Tor and other encrypted communication tools are often used to share CSAM without detection.

2. Social Media Platforms

- Grooming and Exploitation: Perpetrators often use social media to groom and exploit children, leading to the creation and distribution of CSAM.
- Private Groups and Forums: Some platforms host private groups or forums where members share CSAM.

3. Peer-to-Peer (P2P) Networks

- File Sharing: P2P networks facilitate the sharing of CSAM through direct file exchanges, often bypassing traditional internet monitoring.
- Torrents: Torrents are another common method for distributing large quantities of CSAM.

4. Messaging Apps

- Encrypted Messaging: Apps like WhatsApp, Telegram, and Signal, which offer end-to-end encryption, are frequently used to share CSAM.
- Group Chats: Offenders often create and share CSAM in group chats on these platforms.

5. Cloud Storage Services

- Storing and Sharing: Cloud services like Google Drive, Dropbox, and OneDrive can be misused to store and share CSAM.
- Links and Access Codes: Offenders may share links or access codes to cloud storage, facilitating the distribution of CSAM.

6. Online Communities and Forums

- Dedicated Websites: There are specific websites and forums dedicated to the exchange of CSAM, often hidden from standard search engines.
- Underground Networks: These include underground communities that operate discreetly to evade law enforcement.

7. Gaming Platforms

- *In-Game Chat Features*: Some offenders exploit in-game chat features to share CSAM or to groom children for creating CSAM.
- *Private Servers*: Games with private server options can be used to share CSAM discreetly.

8. Live Streaming Services

- *Live Abuse*: Perpetrators may use live streaming services to broadcast abuse, sometimes involving "pay-per-view" setups.
- *Viewer Interactions*: Platforms that allow for real-time viewer interaction can be misused to solicit and share CSAM.

9. Email and Phishing

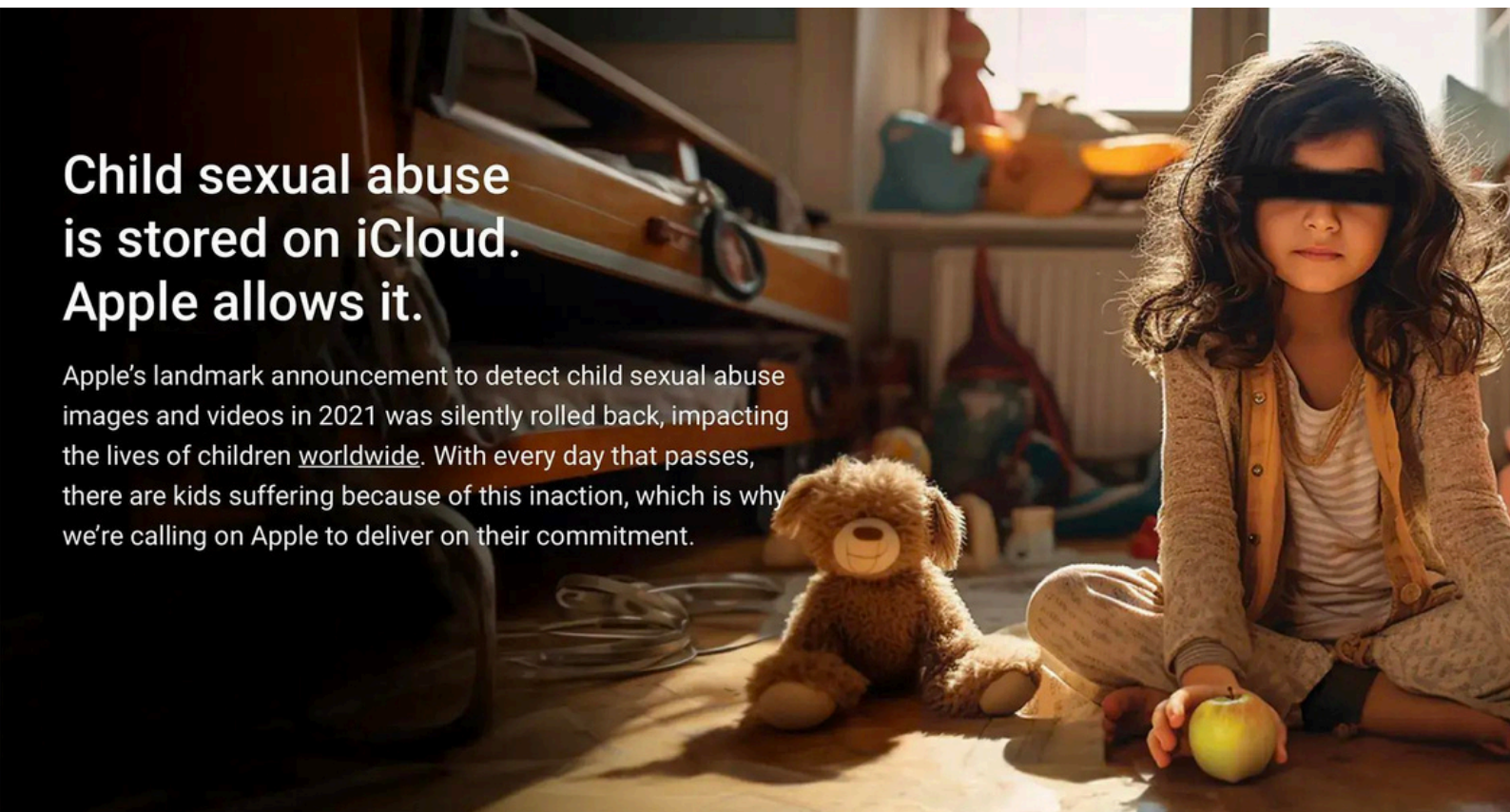
- *Email Attachments*: CSAM is sometimes distributed via email attachments, often using deceptive subject lines to evade detection.
- *Phishing*: Phishing campaigns can trick individuals into providing access to CSAM or exploit their systems to distribute it.

10. Unmonitored Forums and Chatrooms

- *Legacy Platforms*: Older or less regulated platforms may still host forums and chatrooms where CSAM is exchanged.
- *International Sites*: Websites based in countries with lax regulations on online content can be hotspots for CSAM.

Child sexual abuse is stored on iCloud. Apple allows it.

Apple's landmark announcement to detect child sexual abuse images and videos in 2021 was silently rolled back, impacting the lives of children worldwide. With every day that passes, there are kids suffering because of this inaction, which is why we're calling on Apple to deliver on their commitment.



IMPACTS ON VICTIMS

Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) has severe psychological and physical effects on victims, leaving lasting impacts that can persist throughout their lives. These effects are compounded by the continuous circulation of abusive images and videos, which perpetuate the trauma

Psychological effects

- **Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD):** Victims of CSAM often suffer from PTSD, characterized by flashbacks, nightmares, severe anxiety, and uncontrollable thoughts about the abuse. The ongoing accessibility of their abuse material online exacerbates these symptoms, as victims fear that others may have seen or will see their exploitation.
- **Depression and Anxiety:** Chronic depression and anxiety are common among CSAM victims. The sense of shame, guilt, and worthlessness that stems from the abuse can lead to persistent depressive states and heightened anxiety levels. This emotional turmoil often disrupts their daily functioning and social interactions.
- **Self-Harm and Suicidal Ideation:** The intense psychological pain and feelings of helplessness can drive some victims to self-harm or contemplate suicide. Studies have shown that survivors of child sexual abuse, including those depicted in CSAM, have higher rates of suicidal ideation and attempts compared to the general population.
- **Interpersonal Issues:** Trust issues, difficulties in forming and maintaining relationships, and social withdrawal are common among CSAM victims. The betrayal by the abuser, who is often someone they know and trust, leads to a generalized mistrust of others and challenges in establishing healthy relationships.
- **Identity and Self-Esteem Problems:** The exploitation can severely damage a child's developing sense of self and self-esteem. Victims may struggle with their identity and self-worth, often feeling devalued and stigmatized because of the abuse.

Physical effects

- **Physical Injury:** Many children depicted in CSAM suffer physical injuries due to the abusive acts. These injuries can range from minor to severe, including genital trauma, fractures, and internal injuries, depending on the nature and severity of the abuse.
- **Chronic Health Issues:** The stress and trauma from the abuse can lead to long-term health problems. Victims may experience chronic pain, gastrointestinal issues, and other stress-related illnesses throughout their lives.
- **Developmental Delays:** Children subjected to severe and prolonged abuse may experience developmental delays. These can affect their physical growth, cognitive development, and emotional maturation, hindering their ability to reach developmental milestones appropriate for their age.
- **Sexual Health Problems:** Survivors of CSAM may encounter various sexual health issues, including sexually transmitted infections (STIs), complications from forced pregnancies, and long-term reproductive health problems. The trauma also impacts their sexual behavior and attitudes, potentially leading to dysfunctional sexual relationships in adulthood.

Long – term consequences

- **Revictimization:** Victims of CSAM are at a higher risk of revictimization, both online and offline. The presence of their images on the internet can lead to further exploitation and harassment, perpetuating the cycle of abuse.
- **Mental Health Disorders:** The long-term psychological effects can include a range of mental health disorders, such as borderline personality disorder, dissociative disorders, and complex PTSD. These disorders often require long-term, specialized treatment to manage.
- **Impact on Education and Employment:** The trauma from CSAM can disrupt a victim's education, leading to academic difficulties and lower educational attainment. This, in turn, affects their employment opportunities and economic stability in adulthood.

International laws and treaties

International laws on Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) aim to combat the distribution, production, and possession of such material, providing a legal framework for prosecuting offenders and protecting victims. Here are some key international laws and agreements addressing CSAM:

INTERPOL's International Child Sexual Exploitation (ICSE) Database

- This database facilitates international cooperation in the identification of victims and perpetrators of CSAM. Law enforcement agencies worldwide contribute to and access the database, enhancing global efforts to track and dismantle CSAM networks .

Global Alliance against Child Sexual Abuse Online

- Launched by the European Commission and the United States in 2012, this alliance brings together countries to combat online child sexual abuse. Members commit to enhancing efforts in victim identification, improving cooperation, and reducing the availability of CSAM

U.S. Laws (PROTECT Act, Adam Walsh Act)

- The PROTECT Act (2003) and the Adam Walsh Child Protection and Safety Act (2006) are significant U.S. federal laws targeting CSAM. They strengthen penalties for offenders, enhance registration requirements for sex offenders, and improve tools for law enforcement

Australia's Online Safety Act 2021

- This act empowers the eSafety Commissioner to enforce takedown notices for CSAM and mandates internet service providers and platforms to report and remove such content promptly

Convention on Cybercrime (Budapest Convention)

- Adopted in 2001, this convention is the first international treaty seeking to address internet and computer crime by harmonizing national laws and improving investigative techniques. Article 9 specifically targets offenses related to child pornography, including producing, offering, distributing, and possessing such material

Indian legislation

India has implemented several laws and regulations to address Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) through a combination of national legislation and compliance with international conventions. Here are the key pieces of Indian legislation aimed at tackling CSAM:

1. Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), 2012

- The POCSO Act is the primary legislation in India dealing with the sexual abuse and exploitation of children. It provides comprehensive measures to protect children from offenses such as sexual assault, sexual harassment, and pornography. Key provisions related to CSAM include:

Section 13: Defines the use of a child for pornographic purposes.

Section 14: Punishes those who use children for the creation, distribution, and possession of child pornography with imprisonment and fines.

Section 15: Mandates reporting of offenses under the act and penalizes failure to do so

2. Information Technology Act, 2000 (IT Act) and Amendments

- The IT Act provides the framework for addressing cybercrimes, including CSAM. Specific sections related to CSAM include:
- **Section 67B:** Explicitly prohibits the publishing, transmitting, creating, or browsing of child pornography in electronic form. Offenders can face imprisonment up to five years and fines up to ten lakh rupees for a first conviction, with increased penalties for subsequent offenses.
- **Section 69A:** Empowers the government to block public access to information through any computer resource if it is necessary in the interest of sovereignty, integrity, defense of India, friendly relations with foreign states, or public order

3. Indian Penal Code (IPC), 1860

- While the IPC was originally not drafted with digital crimes in mind, it has been amended to address various forms of sexual exploitation, including:
- **Section 292:** Deals with the sale, distribution, and exhibition of obscene material, including pornography, and has been interpreted to cover child pornography.
- **Section 354C:** Covers voyeurism, which can overlap with cases involving the creation and distribution of CSAM

4. Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015

- This act focuses on the care, protection, and rehabilitation of children. It includes provisions for:
- Protecting children from sexual exploitation and abuse.
- Rehabilitating children who have been exploited or abused, including those depicted in CSAM.

5. National Policy for Children, 2013

- This policy underscores the government's commitment to protecting children from all forms of violence, abuse, and exploitation, including sexual abuse and pornography. It mandates the development of specific strategies and action plans to combat these issues effectively.

6. Draft Data Protection Bill, 2019

- While not yet enacted, the draft Data Protection Bill includes provisions that would require entities to report breaches that involve any form of CSAM and ensure the privacy and protection of children's data online



"Every upload and re-upload of Child Sexual Abuse Material represents a failure of our shared responsibility to protect children from crime and violence."

UNODC

www.unodc.org/en/press/2019/01/20190120_BREXITCSAM



Law enforcement agencies and their roles

India's law enforcement agencies play a crucial role in combating child sexual abuse material (CSAM). Here are the primary agencies involved and their roles:

1. Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)

- **Specialized Units:** The CBI has specialized units like the Special Crime Unit which deals with cases involving CSAM.
- **Coordination:** It acts as a nodal agency for coordination with international law enforcement agencies and organizations like INTERPOL for CSAM-related investigations.

2. National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)

- **Data Collection and Analysis:** NCRB collects, compiles, and analyzes crime data, including crimes related to CSAM. It provides insights and trends which help in policy formulation and strategic planning.
- **National Database:** Maintains a national database of sexual offenders, which includes individuals convicted of CSAM-related offenses.

3. National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)

- **Child Rights:** A statutory body that monitors and ensures the protection of child rights. It works in collaboration with law enforcement agencies to address CSAM.
- **Grievance Redressal:** Provides a platform for reporting violations of child rights, including those related to CSAM.

4. National Investigation Agency (NIA)

- **Terrorism and Organized Crime:** While primarily focused on terrorism, the NIA also handles cases involving organized crime, which can include networks distributing CSAM.

5. Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)

- **Policy and Coordination:** MHA formulates policies and coordinates with state governments and law enforcement agencies to ensure effective implementation of laws against CSAM.
- **Cyber Crime Prevention against Women and Children (CCPWC):** A division within MHA that specifically addresses cybercrimes against women and children, including CSAM.

6. Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-IN)

- **Cyber Security:** CERT-IN monitors and responds to cybersecurity incidents. It plays a role in identifying and mitigating the online distribution of CSAM.
- **Reporting Platform:** Operates a platform for reporting incidents related to cybersecurity, including CSAM.

DETECTION AND PREVENTION

Technology used to detect CSAM (AI, machine learning, etc.)

Detecting child sexual abuse material (CSAM) involves a variety of advanced technologies and techniques. Here are the key technologies used:

1. Hash-Based Detection

- *Hashing Algorithms:* Tools like PhotoDNA, MD5, and SHA-1 create unique digital fingerprints (hashes) for known CSAM files. These hashes are then used to detect and block the same files if they are uploaded or shared again.
- *Database of Hashes:* Organizations maintain extensive databases of hashes for known CSAM, allowing for quick identification.

2. Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML)

- *Image and Video Analysis:* AI models are trained to recognize patterns and features typical of CSAM in images and videos.
- *Behavioral Analysis:* AI can analyze user behavior to identify suspicious activities that may indicate the sharing or creation of CSAM.
- *Deep Learning:* Deep learning techniques are employed to improve the accuracy of detecting new and altered CSAM content.

3. Natural Language Processing (NLP)

- *Text Analysis:* NLP tools analyze chat logs, social media posts, and other textual content to identify conversations related to CSAM.
- *Content Moderation:* Automated systems scan for keywords and phrases commonly associated with grooming and CSAM distribution.

4. Image Recognition Software

- *Content Scanning:* Software scans uploaded images on platforms to identify potentially harmful content based on visual characteristics.
- *Facial Recognition:* This technology can identify victims and perpetrators in CSAM by comparing faces in the content to known databases.

5. Video Fingerprinting

- *Unique Identifiers:* This technology creates unique identifiers for video content, similar to hashing, to detect known CSAM videos even if they are altered slightly.

6. Web Crawlers and Scrapers

- *Automated Browsing:* Web crawlers scour the internet, including the dark web, to find and flag CSAM content.
- *Data Collection:* These tools collect data on websites and forums where CSAM is distributed to aid in investigations.

Category	Examples of services/platforms
Image hosting sites	Imgur®, ImageShack™, Flickr®, PostImage
File hosting sites	Megaupload, Dropbox®, WeTransfer™, dl.free.fr
Cloud service providers, virtual private servers, traditional web hosting	Amazon® AWS™, Microsoft® Azure™, Rackspace®, GoDaddy®, DreamHost®
Content delivery networks (CDN)	Cloudflare®, Fastly®, Akamai®
Dark web forums/chats	Sites primarily hosted as onion services on the Tor network.
Search engine results/cache	Google®, Bing®, Yahoo!®, Yandex®
Forums/chats/messaging	Reddit®, Twitch®, 4chan™, Discord™, WhatsApp®, Kik®
Adult pornography sites (fringe)	Specific fetish/interest, revenge pornography
Adult pornography sites (mainstream)	Pornhub®, XVIDEOS™, YouPorn®

7. Metadata Analysis

- *File Information:* Analyzing metadata such as timestamps, geolocation, and device information can help trace the origin and distribution of CSAM files.
- *User Behavior:* Metadata helps track the activities of users involved in CSAM, providing leads for law enforcement.

8. Network Analysis Tools

- *Traffic Monitoring:* Tools monitor network traffic for patterns indicative of CSAM distribution.
- *Deep Packet Inspection (DPI):* DPI examines the contents of data packets being transmitted over a network to identify CSAM.

9. Blockchain Analysis

- *Transaction Tracking:* Blockchain analysis tools track cryptocurrency transactions used to pay for CSAM, helping to identify perpetrators.

10. Content Moderation Platforms

- *Real-Time Monitoring:* Platforms like Guardian, WebPurify, and others provide real-time content moderation services that detect and block CSAM on websites and social media.
- *Human Review:* These platforms often combine automated detection with human review to ensure accuracy.

Precventive measures (education, parental controls, etc.)

Preventive measures for combating child sexual abuse material (CSAM) involve a multifaceted approach, including education, parental controls, technology solutions, and community engagement. Here are some key measures:

1. Education and Awareness

- **For Children**

- *Digital Literacy Programs:* Teach children about internet safety, privacy, and the risks of sharing personal information online.
- *School Curriculums:* Integrate age-appropriate online safety and sex education into school curriculums to empower children with knowledge about CSAM and how to protect themselves.
- *Workshops and Seminars:* Conduct workshops in schools and communities to educate children about the dangers of CSAM and how to report suspicious behavior.

- **For Parents**

- *Parental Training:* Offer training sessions and resources for parents to understand online risks, recognize signs of grooming, and learn how to talk to their children about internet safety.
- *Online Safety Guides:* Provide comprehensive guides and checklists for parents to help them set up and manage online safety measures for their children.

- **For Educators**

- *Professional Development:* Train educators to recognize signs of abuse, handle disclosures appropriately, and integrate online safety education into their teaching.
- *Resource Materials:* Supply schools and teachers with materials and resources to teach children about CSAM and online safety.

2. Parental Controls

- *Device-Level Controls:* Utilize built-in parental control features on devices to limit children's access to inappropriate content and manage screen time.
- *Content Filtering:* Implement software that filters out inappropriate content, including CSAM, on all devices children use.
- *Monitoring Tools:* Use monitoring tools and apps to track children's online activities and receive alerts about suspicious behavior or content.
- *Age-Appropriate Settings:* Ensure children's devices and online accounts are set up with age-appropriate restrictions and privacy settings.

3. Technology Solutions

- *Safe Search Engines:* Encourage the use of child-friendly search engines and activate safe search settings on mainstream search engines.
- *Blocking Software:* Install software that blocks access to known CSAM sites and keywords associated with CSAM content.
- *AI and Machine Learning:* Leverage AI and machine learning to detect and filter out inappropriate content and flag suspicious activities.
- *Encryption and Privacy Tools:* Educate parents and children about using encryption and privacy tools to protect personal information online.

4. Community and Support Networks

- *Hotlines and Reporting Mechanisms:* Establish and promote hotlines and online platforms where children and parents can report suspicious activities or content anonymously.
- *Support Services:* Provide access to counseling and support services for victims of CSAM and their families.
- *Community Programs:* Create community programs that focus on internet safety and the prevention of child exploitation.

5. Legal and Policy Measures

- *Legislation:* Advocate for strong laws and regulations that criminalize the production, distribution, and possession of CSAM, and protect children's rights online.
- *Law Enforcement Training:* Ensure law enforcement officers are trained to handle CSAM cases sensitively and effectively.
- *Collaboration:* Foster collaboration between governments, NGOs, tech companies, and law enforcement agencies to combat CSAM.

6. Engagement with Tech Companies

- *Content Moderation:* Encourage tech companies to implement robust content moderation policies and use advanced technologies to detect and remove CSAM.
- *Reporting Tools:* Ensure platforms have easy-to-use tools for reporting CSAM and other harmful content.
- *Transparency Reports:* Advocate for transparency reports from tech companies detailing their efforts and success in combating CSAM.

7. Public Awareness Campaigns

- *Media Campaigns:* Launch media campaigns to raise awareness about the dangers of CSAM and promote safe online behavior.
- *Social Media Initiatives:* Use social media platforms to spread awareness and provide tips for online safety.

Role of NGOs and other organisations

Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) and other organizations play an extremely important role in fighting Child Sexual Abusive Material (CSAM) through different ways:

Awareness and Education: NGOs work to raise knowledge about CSAM, its effect on children, and how people can report such content. They conduct educational programs in schools, communities, and online to educate both children and adults about the risks connected with CSAM.

Fighting and Policy Development: NGOs fight for stronger laws and policies to prevent the spread of CSAM. They work with governments, police (services businesses/government units), and technology companies to develop and put into use (success plans/ways of reaching goals) to combat CSAM effectively.

Victim Support and Healing: NGOs provide support to victims of CSAM, including counseling, legal help, and healing services. They work to give power to survivors and help them recover from the (serious physical or emotional harm) of abuse.

Working together and Networking: NGOs work together with each other, police (services businesses/government units), technology companies, and other (people who are interested in a project or business) to share information and useful things/valuable supplies in the fight against CSAM. By working together, they can have a more significant effect on fighting the spreading around of CSAM.

Research and Data Analysis: NGOs conduct research to better understand the extent and the range and nature of CSAM. They carefully study data to identify trends, patterns, and new threats, which can inform prevention and policy recommendations.

Hotlines and Reporting: NGOs often operate hotlines and online reporting (machines/methods/ways) for people to report CSAM (without revealing his/her name). By providing a safe and private way for the public to report suspicious content, NGOs help in removing harmful material from circulation.

Well-known NGOs and Organizations Involved in Fighting CSAM

ECPAT International: A worldwide network dedicated to ending the sexual abuse/mistreatment of children, including CSAM.

National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC): Provides services to prevent child kidnapping and sexual abuse/mistreatment, and helps find missing children.

Internet Watch Foundation (IWF): Works to eliminate online child sexual abuse content by identifying and removing such material from the internet.

Thorn: Develops technology to defend children from sexual abusive material and eliminate CSAM from the internet.

Inhope: A network of hotlines fighting online child sexual abuse material by identifying and removing it from the internet.



CASE STUDIES

Recent cases underscore the alarming prevalence of CSAM in India:

->**Madhya Pradesh (2023):**

The National Center for Missing and Exploited Children identified over 30,000 individuals in Madhya Pradesh allegedly involved in circulating suspected CSAM, with over 4,000 cases deemed 'actionable.'

->**Maharashtra (2023):**

'Operation Blackface' by Maharashtra Police led to the arrest of 140 individuals for CSAM-related offenses since the beginning of 2023.

-> **Delhi (2022):**

Delhi Police arrested an individual for sexually assaulting a minor and live-streaming it on social media, highlighting the evolving nature of CSAM.

->**Bhopal CSAM Ring (2022):**

In October 2022, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) uncovered a major CSAM racket operating out of Bhopal. The investigation led to the arrest of five individuals who were found distributing CSAM through various online platforms. This operation was part of a larger crackdown called "Operation Carbon," aimed at dismantling networks involved in the creation and dissemination of CSAM.

->**Operation Megh Chakra (2022):**

Launched in September 2022, Operation Megh Chakra was another significant effort by the CBI to tackle CSAM. Based on inputs from Interpol, the operation involved coordinated raids across multiple states, leading to the seizure of large volumes of electronic devices containing CSAM. This operation highlighted the collaborative efforts between Indian authorities and international organizations to combat child exploitation.

-> **Kerala (2021):**

'Operation P-hunt' by Kerala Police led to the arrest of 100 individuals for CSAM-related offenses, showcasing the increasing focus of law enforcement agencies on tackling CSAM.

->**Hyderabad Case (2020):**

In January 2020, Hyderabad police arrested a 28-year-old man for running a network that produced and distributed CSAM. The accused had been involved in the abuse of several minors, whom he coerced into performing sexual acts while he recorded them. The case came to light when parents of one of the victims reported the abuse, leading to a detailed investigation and subsequent arrest

->**Bengaluru Teacher Case (2019):**

In 2019, a school teacher in Bengaluru was arrested for allegedly sexually abusing students and creating CSAM. The teacher had been recording videos of the abuse and sharing them on the dark web. The case was exposed when a student confided in their parents, prompting an investigation that revealed the teacher's extensive exploitation of minors

->**Gurugram Case (2019):**

In another significant case from 2019, Gurugram police arrested a 32-year-old IT professional who was involved in producing and distributing CSAM. The accused had used sophisticated techniques to hide his activities, but was eventually tracked down through cyber forensic analysis. This case highlighted the need for advanced technological tools and expertise in combating CSAM.

->**Surat Case (2018):**

In 2018, police in Surat arrested a 27-year-old man who was found in possession of over 100,000 images and videos of CSAM. The investigation revealed that the accused had been distributing this material through social media and file-sharing platforms. This case underscored the pervasive nature of CSAM distribution networks and the challenges faced by law enforcement in tracking and prosecuting offenders

->**Prajwala Case**

The Prajwala case is a landmark case that prompted significant legal and policy changes in India regarding CSAM. The NGO Prajwala filed a public interest litigation (PIL) that led the Supreme Court to direct the government to set up a national cybercrime reporting portal. This portal allows citizens to report incidents of child pornography and other cybercrimes, facilitating swift action by authorities.

CONCLUSION

In end, the complete and thorough report on Child Sexual Material (CSAM) has showed about a harsh and upsetting reality about the number and effect of online child abuse/mistreatment. The findings of this report highlight the extremely important need for clear action to combat and prevent CSAM in all its forms.

Through the analysis of data, case studies, and general ways things are going, this report has brought to light the terrible and destructive effects of CSAM on the lives of capable of being hurt children. It has highlighted the sneaky and harmful nature of online abuse/mistreatment, the (existing all over a large area) circulation of harmful material, and the long-term results on the mental and physical well-being of victims.

More than that, the report has highlighted the extreme importance of working together effort among, including governments, police (services businesses/government units), technology companies, NGOs, and the public. Dealing with the many-sided challenges created by or presented by CSAM needs a united and coordinated effort to strengthen prevention, detection, and prosecution methods.

As we face these hidden horrors head-on, the report draws attention to the need for strong and healthy law-based improved solutions, increased and education, and complete and thorough support services for victims and survivors. By putting into use a victim-centered approach and putting in order of importance the protection of children, we can try towards a safer and more secure online (surrounding conditions) for all.

Moving forward, it is extremely important that the findings and recommendations of this report inform policies, and attempts aimed at fighting CSAM. By standing together, raising our voices, and taking real and clear actions, we can create a world where children are safeguarded from abuse/mistreatment and where the hidden horrors of CSAM are no longer tolerated.

**IT'S NOT CHILD
PORNOGRAPHY, STOP
CALLING IT THAT.**

It's Child Sexual Abuse Material.

